

**LONGEST
AMPHIBIAN**

SWAMPLAND STALKER

PRIONOSUCHUS

With its long snout and sharp teeth, *Prionosuchus* resembles modern-day reptiles such as crocodiles, but it was in fact an amphibian. However, while most amphibians are adapted to live on land and in the water, *Prionosuchus* probably spent most of its time below the surface. *Prionosuchus* used its powerful tail to propel its large, streamlined body through the murky waterways of what is now South America. This deadly hunter was probably the top predator in its habitat, feeding on medium-sized fish, as well as primitive sharks, by rapidly swiping at them with its elongated jaws.

AT A GLANCE

- **LENGTH** 30–33 ft (9–10 m)
- **DIET** Carnivore
- **LIVED** 299–272 MYA
- **HABITAT** Swamps



STATS AND FACTS

Prionosuchus was initially only known from several fragments, which contained parts of a skull that was estimated to be just 19½ in (50 cm) long. It wasn't until a much larger jaw fragment was discovered that this amphibian's size could be properly estimated.

At 4 ft (1.2 m), the Chinese giant salamander is the longest amphibian alive today.

The 33-ft (10-m) long *Prionosuchus* was about eight times longer than the Chinese giant salamander.

